



COFFEE, TEA, AND COCOA

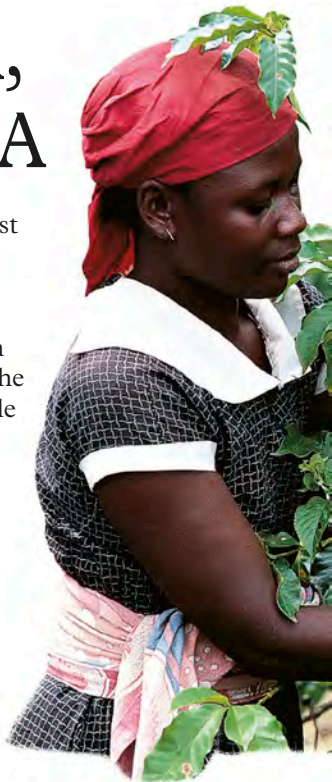


Coffee, tea, and cocoa are drunk in most countries of the world. Cocoa is also used to make chocolate. Coffee and cocoa grow in the tropics. They are grown on huge plantations, but a lot is produced on small farms as well. Tea is grown on plantations in the tropics and subtropics. Altogether, millions of people are employed to produce these crops. Coffee, tea, and cocoa are important to the countries that grow them because they are cash crops. This means they are grown to be traded with other countries rather than for home use.



Picky pickers

Tea comes from evergreen trees that are pruned into bushes. This makes it easy to pick the leaves. The best-quality teas are produced by plucking only the bud and the first two leaves on each shoot. A skilled plucker can pick enough leaves in one day to make 3,500 cups of tea.



Green tea



Black tea



Special treatment

The leaves are made into black or green tea. For green tea, the leaves are dried, heated, and crushed. For black tea, the leaves are dried, crushed, fermented, and dried again.

